# forthe.tech logo FINAL

| Approved | Version | Owner | Tagline |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| 21 October 2026 | 1.0 | Afsal Ali | For the tech. Not because anyone asked. |

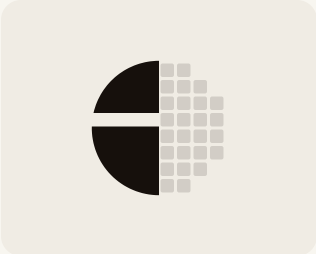
The final forthe.tech logo: what it shows, how it is built, every approved version, and how to use it. It replaces the serif "f." tile. Colours and type are the site's own: ink, paper and clay, Instrument Serif and Inter.




Primary lockup on dark: paper, with the line and the full stop in clay #E67E54.

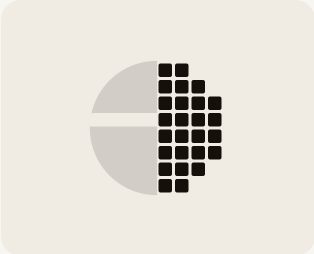
## 01 What the mark shows

One circle, split down the middle. Read it left to right: think, cross the wall, build.



**The smooth half: thinking**

Philosophy, the essays, the idea before it exists. One curve, because thought doesn't come in units.



**The pixel half: building**

Code, screens, the things that ship. Square cells, because software is built one unit at a time.



**The seam: the wall**

What used to stand between having an idea and building it. The site exists because it came down.



**The line: curiosity**

It cuts in from outside, crosses the wall and carries on as built pixels. The only colour.

# Half thought, half built. One line of curiosity breaks through the wall and becomes something built.

The home page says

*“Documenting what happens when the wall between having an idea and building it disappears.”*

The mark draws that sentence: the idea, the wall, and something getting through.



## Why it works

1 **It tells the site's story in one shape.**
Every page is about ideas becoming built things now that the wall has come down. The mark is that idea, small enough for a browser tab.

2 **It's made of what it describes.**
The built half really is pixels on a grid; the thinking half really is one curve. Swap them and the meaning breaks, which is why it never mirrors.

3 **One colour does one job.**
Clay marks the moment curiosity becomes something built, and the full stop in the wordmark. Nothing else on the site is clay, so the two read as one.

4 **It holds at 16 px.**
Three drawings (four, three and two columns) keep the pixels crisp and the clay visible from a share card down to a browser tab.

5 **The details make it ownable.**
Half-solid, half-pixel circles exist elsewhere in tech. The line set one row above centre, and the clay row that carries on as built pixels, are forthe.tech's own.

## How it was chosen

It came out of a long exploration: light through a prism, dots that connect, a wall with a crack, a line that branches, a 13-cell minimal cut. This version won because it tells the idea most plainly and still reads at the smallest sizes. The quieter variant, where the line lands as a single clay pixel, was set aside: at small sizes one pixel is easy to miss, while a whole clay row still reads as a line.



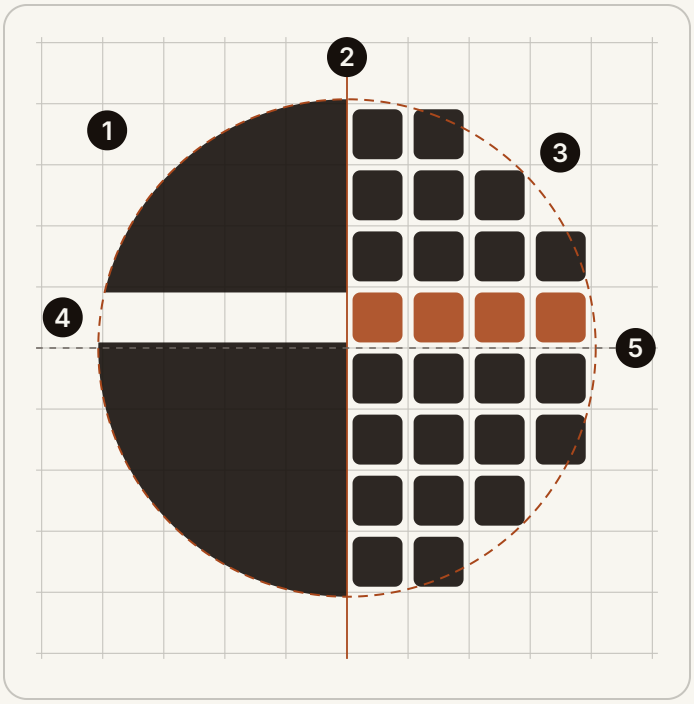
It lands · set aside



**The line becomes built**

# 02 Construction

Drawn on a 32-unit grid, so the master is exact at 32, 64, 128 and 512 px. Every number below is in grid units.




1 circle · 2 seam · 3 cell on its pitch · 4 the line · 5 centre. Faint lines: the 2.75 pixel pitch.

Master measures

| | |
|---|---|
| Grid | 32 × 32 units |
| 1 · Circle | Radius 11.2, centred on (16, 16) |
| 2 · Seam | Vertical at x 16. Smooth left, cells right |
| 3 · Cell | 2.25 square, corner radius 0.35 |
| Pitch | 2.75 (gap 0.5). 4 columns from x 16.25, rows from y 5.25 |
| Keep rule | A cell is drawn only if it sits inside the circle (0.9 tolerance at the rim) |
| 4 · Line | One cell high: y 13.5 to 15.75. Cut through the smooth half, from the rim to the seam |
| 5 · Centre | The line sits one row above it |
| Clay | The 4 cells on the line's row |
| Count | 26 cells: 22 ink, 4 clay |

**Why one row above centre.** On the centre the line would read as an equator, something that belongs to the circle. One row up, it reads as something arriving from outside.

## Three drawings, one mark

As the mark gets smaller the cells get fewer and bigger, so the pixel half never turns to grey mesh. The line stays exactly one cell high.



**Master · 48 px and up**
4 columns · cell 2.25 · pitch 2.75 · line y 13.5 · 26 cells



**32 px cut · 24–47 px**
3 columns · cell 3.1 · pitch 3.7 · line y 12.6 · 12 cells



**16 px cut · under 24 px**
2 columns · cell 4.6 · pitch 5.4 · line y 11 · 6 cells

# 03 Logo models

Four models: the primary lockup, the stacked lockup, the mark and the wordmark. Use the primary lockup wherever there is room; the mark alone where the name is already close by or space is tight.

### 3.1 Primary lockup




On paper (primary): ink, clay #A8471B




On dark: paper #F7F5EF, clay #E67E54




On paper deep #F0ECE4: same as on paper

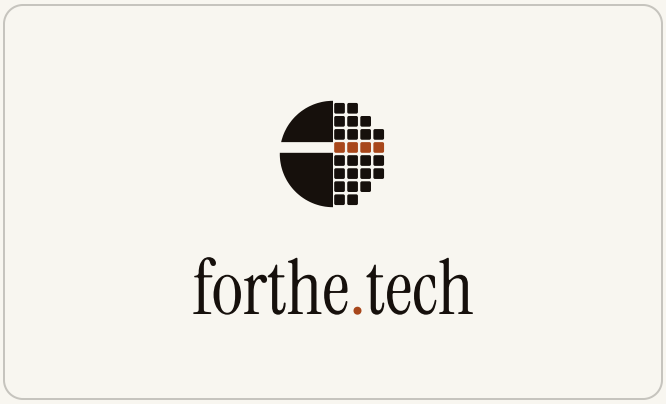


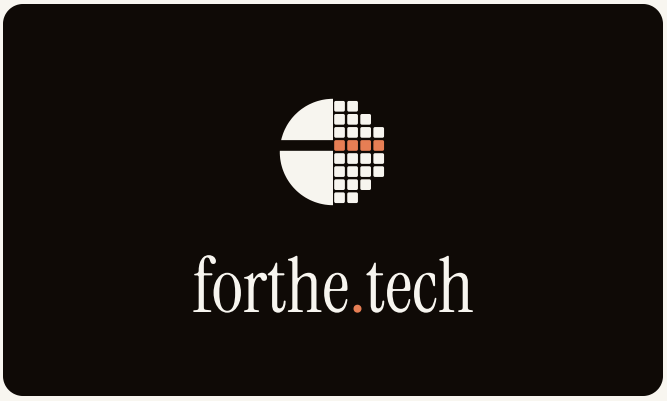

One colour: all ink, or all paper on dark

| Unit | Mark box | Gap | Alignment |
|---|---|---|---|
| F = wordmark font size | 1.25 F square | 0.35 F | Centred on each other; wordmark at line-height 1 |

### 3.2 Stacked lockup

For square and tall spaces: the About page header, a talk slide, a profile banner.

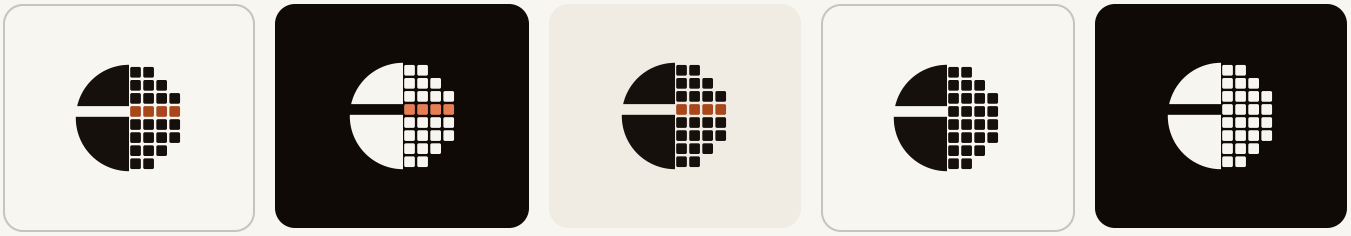



Stacked: mark box 2 F, gap 0.25 F, both centred on one vertical axis.

### 3.3 The mark

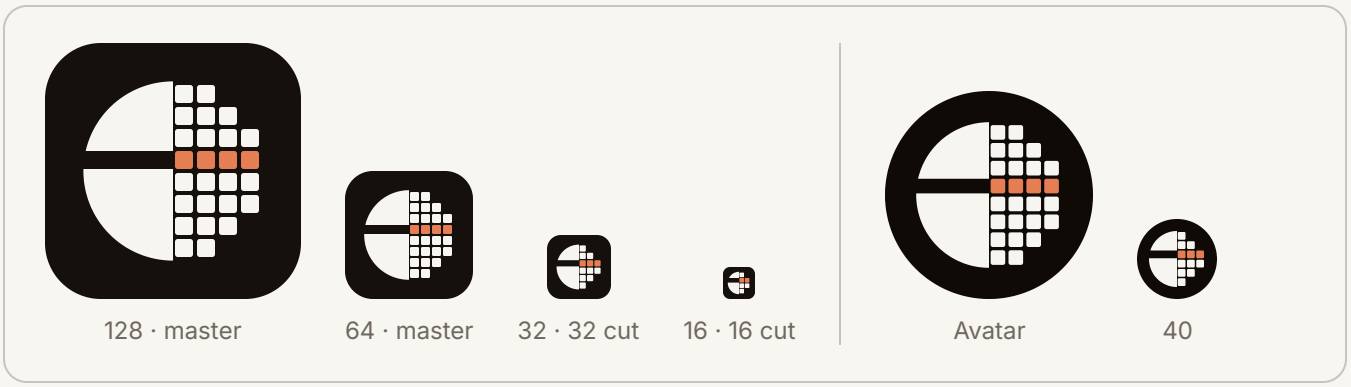
The mark alone, for places where the name is already on screen or close by: a favicon, an avatar, the foot of a project page. Same colour rules as the lockup.



On paper | On dark | On paper deep | One colour, ink | One colour, paper

### 3.4 App icon, favicon and avatar

On an ink tile so it holds on any browser theme or home screen. The mark box fills the tile; its circle takes 70% of the side. Each size uses the drawing made for it.



128 · master | 64 · master | 32 · 32 cut | 16 · 16 cut | Avatar | 40

| | |
|---|---|
| Favicon | Ink #16100C tile, corner radius 7 of 32 (22%). 32 cut at 32 px, 16 cut at 16 px. Same tile in light and dark browsers. |
| Home-screen icon | 180 × 180, square and full-bleed on dark #0F0A06; the phone rounds the corners. Master drawing. |
| Avatar | GitHub, LinkedIn and similar: dark #0F0A06 ground, mark box = the avatar's diameter, so it survives a round crop. 32 cut under 48 px. |
| Never | A clay tile, a gradient tile, or the mark shrunk inside a tile with a wide margin. |

### 3.5 Wordmark

The name set in the site's display face. The full stop is the only clay in it, and it matches the mark's line.

forthe.tech

| | |
|---|---|
| Typeface | Instrument Serif Regular (400). Free under the SIL Open Font License; the site loads it from @fontsource. |
| Case and spacing | All lowercase, one word, default letter spacing. |
| Colour | Ink with a clay full stop (#A8471B on paper, #E67E54 on dark), or one colour throughout. |
| In running text | Plain "forthe.tech" in the surrounding font. No clay, no serif, no logo. |
| Never | ForThe.tech · Forthe.Tech · for the tech · FORTHE.TECH · italic · a dot drawn as a pixel cell |

### 3.6 Size range

Sizes are the mark's square box, not the circle. Pick the drawing by the size it will actually show at; on high-density screens that is the CSS size.

| Drawing | On screen | In print | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| Master | 48 px and up | 10 mm and up | Every lockup above the minimum |
| 32 px cut | 24–47 px | 7–10 mm | Header at 1×, small avatars, 32 px favicon |
| 16 px cut | 16–23 px | 5–7 mm | Favicon only; never in a lockup |
| Lockup floor | Mark box 24 px | 7 mm | Smaller than this, use the mark alone |
| Below 16 px | Don't use | Under 5 mm | Set the wordmark alone instead |



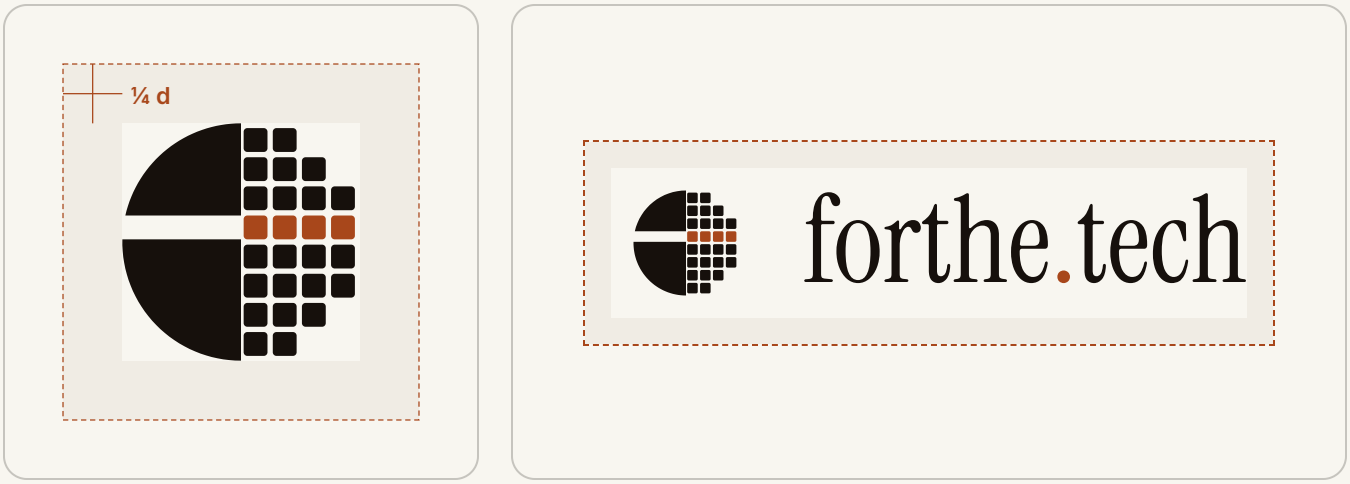

96 · master | 48 · master | 32 · 32 cut | 24 · 32 cut | 16 · 16 cut | Smallest lockup

Shown at real size.

# 04 Usage rules

## 4.1 Clear space

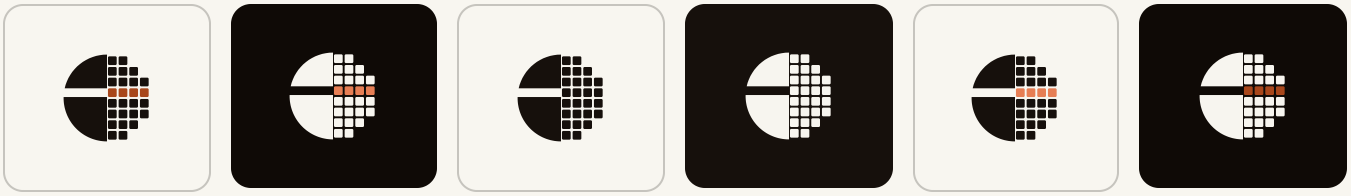
Keep a quarter of the circle's diameter empty on every side: 5.6 grid units, measured from the circle's edge (and, in a lockup, from the wordmark's letters). No text, edge, image or other graphic enters it.




d = circle diameter (22.4 of 32 units). In the lockup, ¼ d ≈ 0.22 × the wordmark's font size.

## 4.2 Colour pairings

Four approved pairings. The two clays are not interchangeable: each one only works on its own ground.



**Yes.** Ink + clay #A8471B on paper

**Yes.** Paper + clay #E67E54 on dark

**Yes.** Ink only, on any light ground

**Yes.** Paper only, on any dark ground

**No.** #E67E54 on paper: 2.6:1

**No.** #A8471B on dark: 3.4:1

## 4.3 Backgrounds

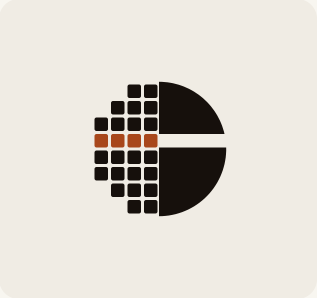
**Solid grounds only.** Paper, paper deep, ink or the dark ground. These are the site's own colours.

**Over screenshots or video,** sit the mark on a solid paper or dark panel with full clear space. Never straight on the image.

**Never on clay,** a gradient, a pattern or the grain texture turned up. Clay is for the line, not the ground.

### 4.4 Don't

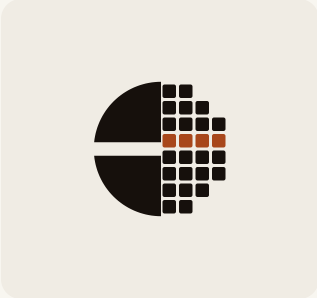
Every one of these breaks either the meaning (thinking on the left, one line, one colour) or the drawing. Use the supplied files; never redraw the mark.



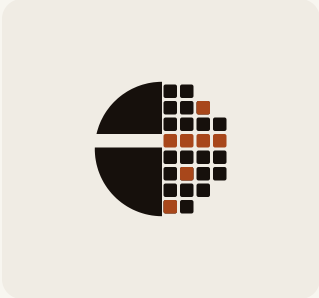
✕ Don't mirror it. Thinking stays on the left.



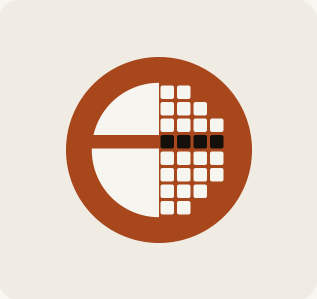
✕ Don't rotate it.



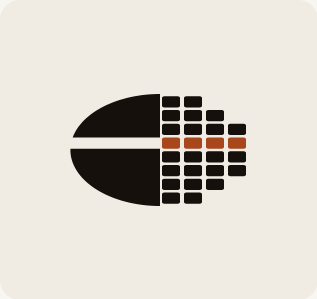
✕ Don't move the line onto the centre or off its row.



✕ Don't add clay pixels. One line, one row.



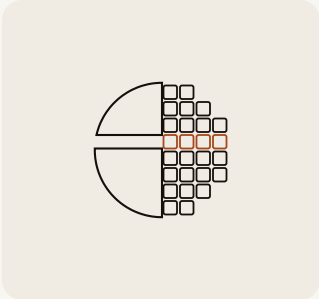
✕ Don't put it in a coloured circle or badge.



✕ Don't stretch or squash it.



✕ Don't recolour the line. Clay only.



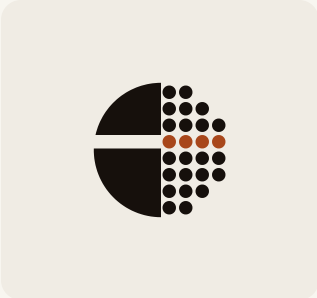
✕ Don't outline it. The halves are solid.



✕ Don't add shadows, glows or gradients.



✕ Don't set it on mid-tones. Use paper or dark.



✕ Don't redraw the cells as dots or resize them.




✕ Don't retype the wordmark or change its case.

**When in doubt,** use the primary lockup or the mark from the supplied files, on paper or dark, at a listed size, with clear space. Anything else needs a new version of this guide.

# 05 Colour specification

Six colours, all taken from the site's own tokens (OKLCH in `src/styles.css`). There are two clays: a darker one for light grounds and a lighter one for dark grounds.

**Ink · mark on light**
#16100C · RGB 22 16 12
OKLCH 0.18 0.012 60 · --ink
CMYK 0 27 45 91

**Paper · light ground**
#F8F6F0 · RGB 248 246 240
OKLCH 0.972 0.008 90 · --paper
CMYK 0 1 3 3

**Clay · line on light**
#A8471B · RGB 168 71 27
OKLCH 0.52 0.14 42 · --accent-ink
CMYK 0 58 84 34

**Dark · dark ground**
#0F0A06 · RGB 15 10 6
OKLCH 0.15 0.012 60 · dark --paper
CMYK 0 33 60 94

**Light · mark on dark**
#F7F5EF · RGB 247 245 239
OKLCH 0.97 0.008 90 · dark --ink
CMYK 0 1 3 3

**Clay on dark · line on dark**
#E67E54 · RGB 230 126 84
OKLCH 0.70 0.14 42 · --mark-dot
CMYK 0 45 63 10

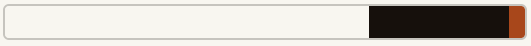
CMYK figures are straight conversions of the screen colours: a starting point for a printer's proof, not a press standard. No Pantone matches are chosen yet.

### Contrast, computed (WCAG 2.1)

WCAG exempts logos from its contrast rules. forthe.tech holds the mark to the 3 : 1 graphics standard anyway and only ships pairings that clear it with room.

| Pairing | Ratio | Use |
|---|---|---|
| Ink on paper | 17.5 : 1 | Yes |
| Clay #A8471B on paper | 5.4 : 1 | Yes (5.0 : 1 on paper deep) |
| Light #F7F5EF on dark | 18.1 : 1 | Yes |
| Clay #E67E54 on dark | 7.0 : 1 | Yes (6.7 : 1 on the ink tile) |
| Clay #A8471B on dark | 3.4 : 1 | No: too dim beside the light mark |
| Clay #E67E54 on paper | 2.6 : 1 | Never: fails 3 : 1 |

**Share of colour.** Paper carries the page, ink carries the words, and clay is only ever a few pixels: the line and the full stop.



# 06 Applications

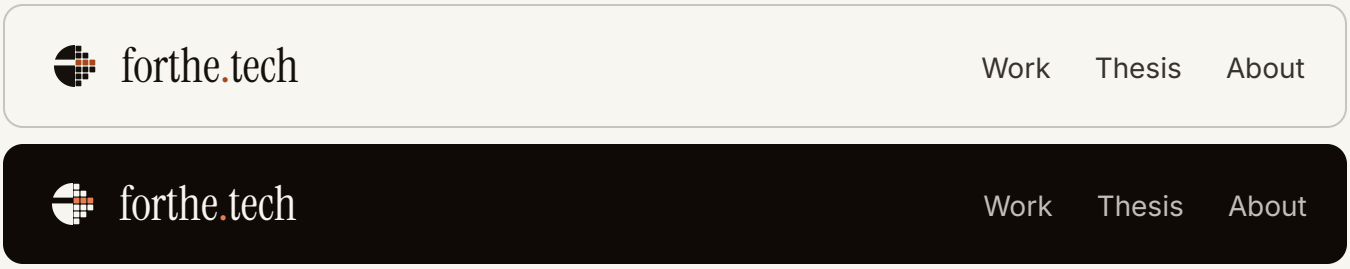
Where the logo actually appears, in the order people meet it: the browser tab, the site header, and the card that unfurls when a link is shared.

### 6.1 Browser tab



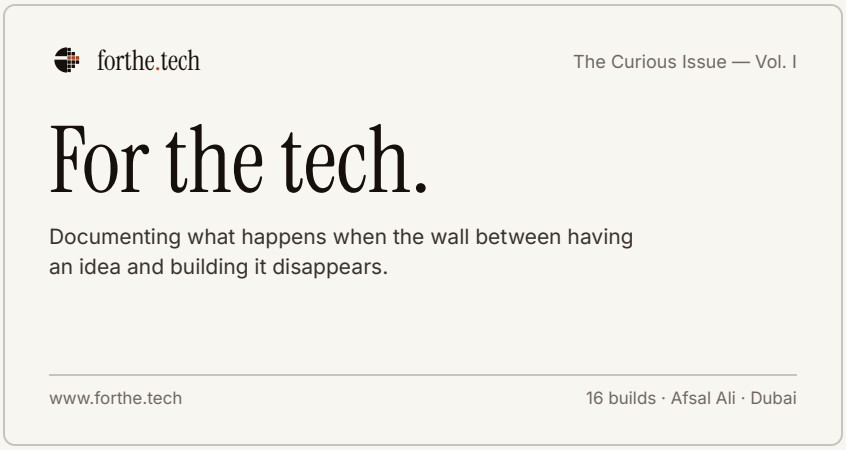

The same ink tile in light and dark browsers, drawn with the 16 px cut.

### 6.2 Site header




Primary lockup, 32 px cut at 30 px, wordmark 24 px. The colours follow the theme: clay #A8471B in light, #E67E54 in dark. The lockup links home.

### 6.3 Share card · 1200 × 630



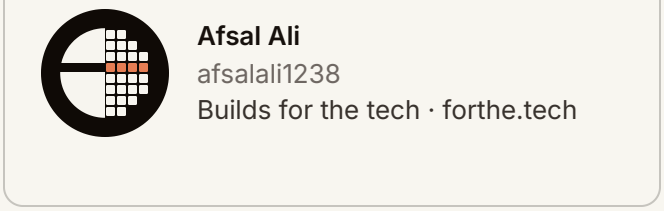

**Layout.** Paper ground. Lockup top left (mark box 50 px, wordmark 40 px, master drawing), kicker top right, title in Instrument Serif, one line of Inter below, a 2 px rule, then the URL and three facts. Full spec in the brand guidelines, 2.13.

**One card per page.** Project cards swap the title for the project name and the kicker for "Built for … · year".

**Retired.** The large faint "f" in the corner goes with the old tile. No watermark.

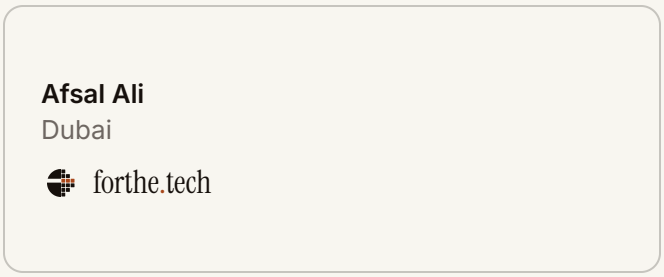
Shown at 35%.

### 6.4 Profile avatar



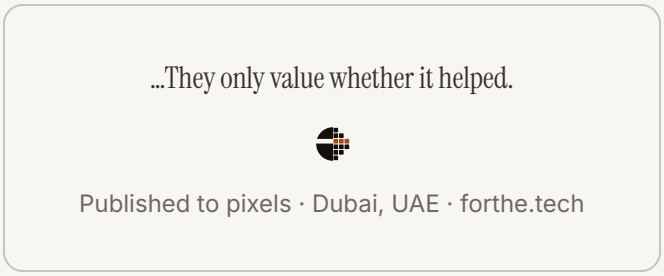

GitHub, LinkedIn page, Medium: the round avatar from 3.4.

### 6.5 Email signature




A PNG of the lockup at 2×, linked to www.forthe.tech. Never the favicon tile.

### 6.6 Essay end mark




The mark closes a Dispatch, centred, 24 px, above the sign-off.

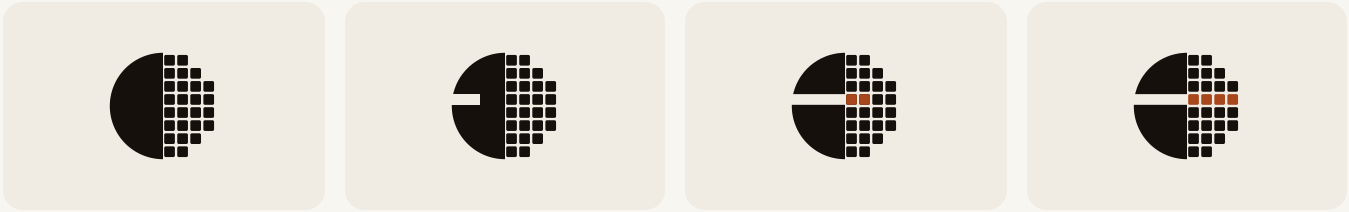
### 6.7 Talk or video title




16:9 on dark. Lockup top left; the title does the talking.

## 07 Motion

The logo can tell its own story once: the line cuts in, then the row is built. It plays a single time and then stays still.



**0 s** · whole: thought and build, no line yet

**0–0.6 s** · the line cuts in from the left

**0.6–1.2 s** · the row is built, one cell at a time

**1.2 s** · done. It stays like this.

| | |
|---|---|
| Timing | Cut 0.6 s on cubic-bezier(0.65, 0, 0.35, 1); then 4 cells, 0.12 s apart, each fading to clay in 0.2 s on the site's ease, cubic-bezier(0.22, 1, 0.36, 1). |
| Where | The home page on first load and the 404 page. Once per visit. |
| Reduced motion | Show the final frame. No animation at all. |
| Never | Loop it, play it on hover or scroll, animate the favicon, or move the mark around the page. |

# 08 Production and files

### Production notes

| | |
|---|---|
| Screen | SVG wherever it's supported. PNG at 2× only where SVG isn't (email, some social uploads). |
| The site | favicon.svg, favicon.ico and apple-touch-icon.png go in `public/`. The header draws the mark inline so it follows the theme's clay. |
| Share cards | 1200 × 630 PNG per page in `public/og/`, rebuilt with the new lockup and no "f" watermark. |
| Print | Vector only (SVG or PDF). Start from the CMYK figures, ask for a proof, and check clay on uncoated stock: it prints darker. |
| One ink | Engraving, embossing, a stamp: the mono files. The line stays as the cut through the smooth half. |

### Files

In the `logo-final` folder. "ink" files are for light grounds, "paper" files for dark. The wordmark in every lockup is outlined, so no font is needed.

| File | Use |
|---|---|
| `lockup-ink.svg · lockup-paper.svg` | Primary lockup |
| `lockup-stacked-ink.svg · -paper.svg` | Stacked lockup |
| `wordmark-ink.svg · wordmark-paper.svg` | Wordmark alone |
| `mark-ink.svg · mark-paper.svg` | Master mark, 48 px and up |
| `mark-32cut-ink.svg · -paper.svg` | 24–47 px |
| `mark-16cut-ink.svg · -paper.svg` | 16–23 px |
| `mark-ink-mono.svg · mark-paper-mono.svg` | One colour |
| `favicon.svg · favicon-16.svg · favicon.ico` | Browser tab (ico holds 16, 32, 48) |
| `apple-touch-icon.png` | Home screen, 180 × 180 |
| `mark-ink-512.png · mark-paper-512.png` | Raster, transparent |

**Open decisions**

Pantone matches for the two clays (none until something is printed). Building the logo animation into the site (specified in 07, not yet coded). Rules for merchandise or embroidery, if that ever happens.

**Changelog**

**v1.0 · 21 October 2026.** First release. The half-pixel mark with the line set one row above centre is approved as final. It replaces the serif "f." tile everywhere.